UK Data Service

# Sixty years of social science data sharing: legal and ethical frameworks in practice at the UK Data Archive

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Economic and Social Research Council

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# UK Data Service (UKDS)

Funded from 2012 by the Economic and Social Research Council to provide users with access, support, guidance and training to facilitate high quality social and economic research and education.

Hosts UK's largest collection of social, economic and population research data.

A partnership between UK Data Archive at University of Essex, Cathie Marsh Institute for Social Research at University of Manchester, Jisc, UK, EDINA from University of Edinburgh, and the Department of Information Studies and Centre for Advanced Spatial Analysis at UCL.

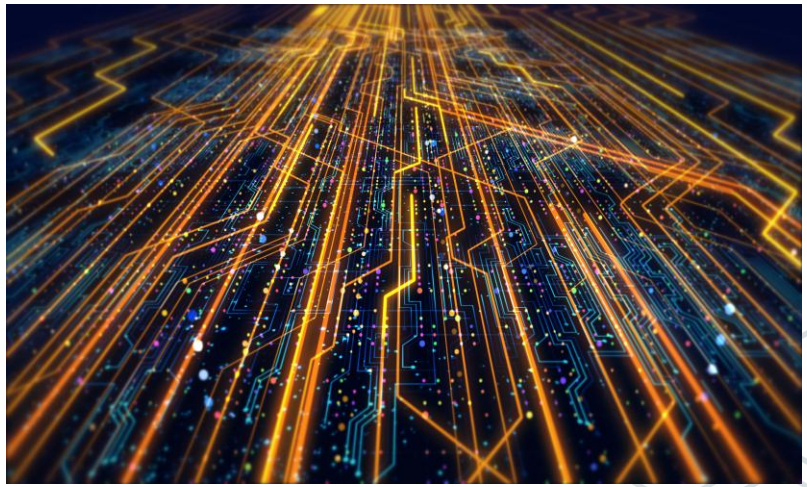
ukdataservice.ac.uk

# Stats about UKDS

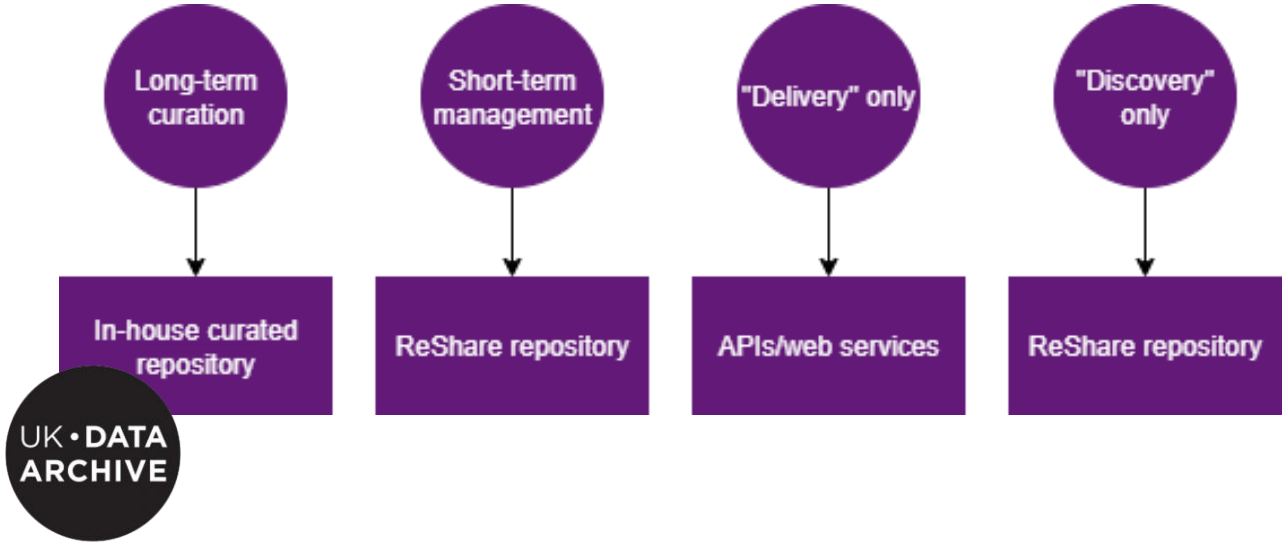
- ~ 10,000 data collections
- ~ 300 new studies and new editions added each year.
- ~ 52,000 registered users
- ~ 190,000 data accesses worldwide p.a.

**UKDS data collections are accessed every 3 minutes**

**24 x 7 x 365**



# Collections development policy



Available here.

# Assessing fit, value and risk

Stage 1: Strategic value.

Stage 2: Analytic usefulness.

Stage 3: Usability and accessibility.

**Determines curation category, including preservation pathway, licence negotiations and access tier.**

# UK Data Archive (UKDA)

Lead partner of UK Data Service, providing trusted access to over 6,500 high-quality, curated data collections, working alongside other partners to deliver national data infrastructure.

Founded in 1967, we set standards and deliver training for responsible data sharing, always balancing openness with protection.

Pioneers in long-term digital preservation, citation practices (DOIs), and metadata standards, enabling FAIR data sharing.

www.data-archive.ac.uk/

# UKDA evolution

**1967**
Social Science Research Council Data Bank

**1972**
Survey Archive

**1982**
SSRC Data Archive

**1984**
ESRC Data Archive

**1996**
The Data Archive

**2000**
UK Data Archive

Continuous outreach, guidance and education & free service

# UKDA data portfolio

Browse by theme

- Ageing
- COVID-19
- Crime
- Economics
- Environment and energy
- Education
- Ethnicity
- Food
- Health
- Housing
- Information and communication
- Labour
- Politics
- Poverty

Browse by data type

- UK Surveys
- Cross-national surveys
- Longitudinal studies
- International macrodata
- Census data
- Business microdata
- Qualitative/mixed methods
- Administrative data
- International Data Access Network

Access the data catalogue here.

- Large-scale government-funded surveys
- Major UK surveys following individuals over time
- Census data 1851 – 2021
- Business microdata and administrative data
- Microdata and administrative data
- Range of qualitative collections

# Deposit licence agreement

UK Data Service ukdataservice.ac.uk

Deposit Licence Agreement

Copy for review – do not sign

Available here.

Grants the Archive **non-exclusive rights** to preserve and disseminate data.

Data creators **maintain ownership** while enabling broader reuse.

Allows the negotiation of **reuse/access conditions** to protect confidentiality, sensitive content, and/or IPR.

# Data spectrum – tiered access

**Open**

No real disclosure risk – anonymous data or consent to share data as collected is in place. Under open licences for reuse such as Creative Commons; almost no restrictions for reuse.

**Safeguarded**

Risk of identification is considered sufficiently remote – effectively anonymised data (ICO). Use of data bound by the terms and conditions of the End User Licence Agreement; special conditions or agreements might apply.

**Controlled**

Real disclosure risk – TRE/SDE function – de-identified data, and/or highly sensitive commercially or otherwise. Available under the full 5 Safes Framework and subject to the Secure Access User Agreement.

# Data spectrum – in practice

## Millennium Cohort Study

Abstract FAQ's Resources Access data

**Access data**

GN 33359
Millennium Cohort Study – Survey and Biomeasures Data

GN 33445
Millennium Cohort Study - Linked Administrative Data

GN 33557
Millennium Cohort Study - Linked Geographical Data

GN 33559
COVID-19 Survey in Five National Longitudinal Cohort Studies

GN 33601
Harmonised Data in Five National Longitudinal Cohort Studies

## Understanding Society

Abstract FAQ's Resources Access data

**Access data**

GN 33423
Understanding Society: Waves 1- , 2008-

GN 33428
Understanding Society, Waves 1-, 2008- : Special Licence Access

GN 33429
Understanding Society: Waves 1- , 2008-: Secure Access

## Crime Survey for England and Wales

Abstract FAQ's Resources Access data

**Access data**

GN 33174
Crime Survey for England and Wales, 1982-

GN 33465
Crime Survey for England and Wales, 2011- : Secure Access

## National Travel Survey

Abstract FAQ's Resources Access data

**Access data**

GN 33238
National Travel Survey, 1972-

GN 33481
National Travel Survey, 2002- : Secure Access

GN 33482
National Travel Survey, 1995- : Special Licence Access

GN 33570
National Travel Attitudes Study, 2019-

## Family Resources Survey

Abstract FAQ's Resources Access data

**Access data**

GN 33283
Family Resources Survey, 1993-

GN 33457
Family Resources Survey, 2005/06- : Secure Access

# Looking ahead

- Emerging regulatory landscape
- Dynamic consent models
- Responsible AI
- Federation
- Global harmonisation

# Any questions?

UK Data Service

# Thank you.

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